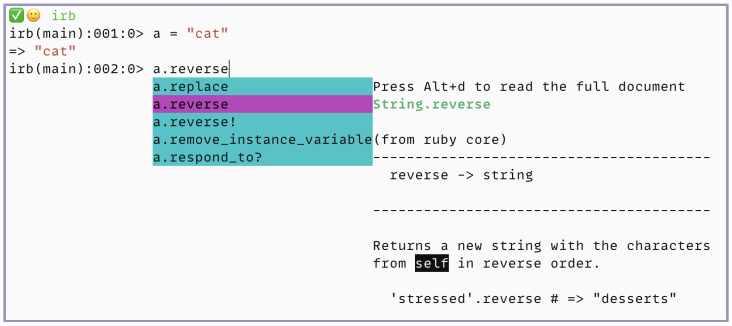
1 + 1 expression, until you eventually come back to where you started and type end to complete the method expression.

Starting in Ruby 3.1, irb has its own native autocompletion functionality. When you press Tab partway through a word, irb will look for possible completions that make sense at that point. If there is only one, irb will fill it in automatically, and it will show you the beginning of the documentation for that completion, if there is documentation.

If there are multiple completions, irb will display them in a list, pressing Tab again will move you through the list of completions, each one displaying its documentation when selected, and then pressing Return will complete the selected entry.

For example, the following image shows the middle of an irb session:



In this session, we assigned a string object to the variable a. Now we want to try the method reverse on this object. The screenshot here comes from typing a.re and hitting Tab twice.

You can see that irb lists all the methods supported by the object in a whose names start with *re*, and that reverse is now selected, and that irb has filled out our input line with reverse—all we typed was a.re<tab><tab>. The documentation from the method is now also displayed.

irb responds to the Return key by expanding the name as far as it can go, in this case completing the word reverse. If we keyed Tab twice at this point, it would show us the current options, reverse and reverse!. However, because reverse is the one we want, we instead hit Return again, and the line of code is executed.

Tab completion isn't limited to built-in names. If we define a class in irb, then tab completion works when we try to invoke one of its methods: